

## BOB INGRAM Vince, Sun Bowl fans of Tigers



KEMENDO

WITH AN EXTRA dollar in his pocket to insure that he will not be stuck in W.C. Fields' favorite city, Vincent Kemendo will go to Philadelphia on March 27 to see the NCAA basketball finals.

He hopes that one of the four finalists who gather in the City of Brotherly Love will be the University of Missouri Tigers.

The Tigers will play in the next Sun Bowl Tournament. They are the champions of the Big Eight Conference and are in the NCAA playoffs that start this week.

If the Tigers can go through the eliminations and get to Philly for the big shootout, it would raise the prestige of the Sun Bowl meet next December. If the Missourians would come here as the NCAA champions that would certainly be something for the band to strike up for.

Kemendo, who is chairman of the Sun Bowl basketball tournament selection committee, is proud of the fact that five of 10 teams that come to future El Paso meets are in NCAA post-season play or in the National Invitation Tournament.

Besides Missouri, they are Kansas State and Memphis State who'll be here in 1977, Michigan which will play in the 1978 Sun Bowl meet and Texas Tech, which will be also here that year, playing for sure in the new UTEP Special Events Center.

### Far into the future

SUN BOWL TOURNAMENT teams have been selected through 1978 and one visiting team has been picked for 1979. Since UTEP is always the host team, only outsiders are mentioned when it comes to talking about the future fields.

The 1976 field has Missouri, Southern California and Baylor. All have been here before. Missouri wound up the season with a 24-4 record, Baylor was 12-15 and Southern Cal, which definitely had an off year, was 11-16. The hosting Miners were 19-7.

For 1977 the visiting teams with their current season records are: Kansas State 20-7, Memphis State 20-8, Army 11-14. Of this trio, only Army has failed to play in the Sun Bowl meet.

For 1978, Michigan, Clemson and Texas Tech head the outside field. Their records this year: Michigan 21-6, Clemson 18-10, Texas Tech 21-5.

Houston, which finished the present season with a 17-10 record, is the only team in the 1979 field chosen so far, outside of UTEP.

One of Kemendo's missions in Philadelphia will be to get two other teams for the 1979 field and go on from there to future meets.

### N.C. teams sought

KEMENDO HAS several ideas and paths to pursue in his talks with the basketball coaches who'll be in Philly. He'd like to get North Carolina and North Carolina State

## Troopers can bag a 'first'

By BOB INGRAM

Eastwood High School Troopers would mark up a first if they win the state high school basketball championship this week at Austin.

They wouldn't be the first El Paso team to accomplish the feat but they would be the first team other than El Paso High to do it.

Teams from El Paso High School have won the top prep basketball crown in Texas three times.

EL PASO Tigers, coached by the late Luther Coblenz, had the distinction of winning the very first one held, in 1921.

Andy Cohen, who is "Mr. Baseball in El Paso," was a member of that team.

Those were the years that El Paso High went to the state meet virtually every year.

BUT IT WAS 20 years before El Paso won another championship. Jewell Wallace's 1941 team captured the crown.

Six years later, C. D. Jarvis took his Tigers to Austin. The Tigers captured the 1947 championship by beating Dallas Crozier Tech 37-36, Greenville 49-31 and San Antonio Thomas Jefferson 27-22.

A reunion of the 1947 team was held a couple of years ago.

Members of the team were: Pete Gonzalez, George Mengel, Stanley Blaugrund, Bobby Parra, Robert Mena, Raymond Esquibel, Eddy Jabolie, Robert Avina, Jose Palafox, Morgan Broaddus, Richard Montoya and Ramon Orona.

The 1941 El Paso High team defeated Mount Vernon 28-25, Houston Thomas Jefferson 37-22 and Abilene 27-20.

Members of the team were Yvon Rechy, Steve Minas, Francisco Salas-Porras, Fernando Palafox, Mike Izquierdo, Gordon Brandon, James Allen, Milton Chernov, Mario Palafox, Bob Hoover, Ralph Mamolejo, Bobby Goldfarb and Buddy Ward.

out here. Neither has ever played in the Sun Bowl meet. Perhaps Auburn has spread the S.B. gospel in that part of the country.

The Sun Bowl is interested in bringing Bobby Knight and the Indiana Hoosiers back to El Paso. Knight and Indiana were here four years ago when some of his current Indiana players were freshmen.

The big prize naturally for the Sun Bowl would be to land UCLA, the perennial NCAA champions. So far, UCLA has been cool to any Sun Bowl bids. "They can stay at Pauley Pavillion and make \$30,000," said Vince.

The Sun Bowl people would like to have a Southwest Conference team every year or almost every year for the simple reason that most of the SWC schools have large local followers who would be sure to buy tickets.

Selling tickets hasn't been a big problem so far for the Sun Bowl. But when the tournament is moved from the small Memorial Gym to the new UTEP basketball mansion, the problem could be important since there will be so many more seats to fill.

Oh, yes, about that extra dollar Kemendo is taking to Philadelphia. That city taxes everyone leaving its environs \$1. Vince doesn't wish to remain a captive of that city very long, no matter how charming it may be in this Bicentennial year.